# GFX2.X

## User Guide

Document Version: 23.01.01




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# Preface

## About this guide

This user guide is providing information about the **GFX2.X** which is a Windows based Graphics Server developed for rendering graphics over the running video output. This document is describing in detail the features of GFX2.X and their respective use. This will guide you to set GFX2.X Configurations, manually controlling the Graphics Playout, capture input video source and render the output with graphics overlayed.

## Intended audience

This software user guide is intended for playout engineers, operators and software support personnel that are engaged in and are responsible for GFX2.X software installation, setup, troubleshooting, and graphics playout operations.

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# 1. Introduction to GFX2.X

**GFX2.X** is a Windows based graphics delivery application server developed by Planetcast. This software is developed for media broadcasting industry where it can be used as an automation system for rendering the graphics over the running video source. The **GFX2.X** works with **Playout Automation Server** and the **Graphics Agent** where the Playout Automation Server send UDP command to Graphics Agent to Load/Unload Graphics from running video. The Playout Automation Server also send primary video source stream to Graphics Server over which the Graphics are rendered. The Graphics Agent serves as the central command center that receives UDP command from Playout Automation Server, initialize the graphics to be rendered and command the GFX2.X to render the Graphics Template over the running video stream generating from Playout Automation Server. On receiving the command from Graphics Agent, GFX2.X play/render the corresponding graphics (i.e Logo, Aston, Bug, Text Overlay, Ticker, Images, Subtitles etc.) over the running video source.

GFX2.X is extremely powerful and efficient in playing single or multiple graphics over the running video in a single time. Its function is to combine graphics with video at the input of the Decklink card and Keying them. It supports SDI, NDI sources as input and render output over SDI and/or NDI. It is capable of playing Aston, Logo, Bug, Ticker, Text Overlay, Image, Countdown Timer, Subtitles, Digital Watch, L-Band, R-Band, U-Band, Now, Next, Later, PIP, Backin etc. It supports rendering 2 logo files (1 Channel Logo + 1 Fest Logo) at the same time with interrupting the playback of primary channel logo, and allow user to fire Emergency Alert Message on screen in real-time for emergency situations.

The GFX2.X is facilitated with a highly intuitive and easy-to-use GUI for user interaction. It helps user to set channel-wise server configuration, graphics template configuration, source capture properties, output rendering properties and manual graphics playout controlling. In manual controlling, it allows defining the properties for GFX files, Text Overlay, Text Offset, Ticker Text, Image display, Image Scroll, Countdown Timer, Digital Watch, Video Skewing, and Subtitles properties. Also it allows taking the complete GFX2.X server backup and restore the stored backup back to the GFX2.X server.

GFX2.X is a reliable and cost-effective graphics delivery software that can be installed on a standard hardware of good configurations. It can be integrated with major Playout Automation such as D-Series, ADC, Media.X etc., for productive graphics playout.

# 2. Key Features

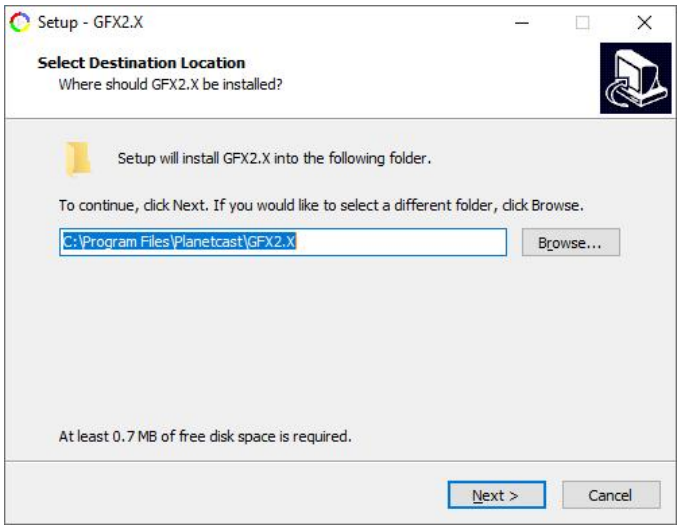
1. Offers full automation and manual control.
2. Offers a highly intuitive graphical user interface for manual interaction.
3. Supports SD, HD character generation.
4. Supports SDI, NDI sources as input and render graphics output over SDI and NDI.
5. Supports .MOV graphics file format.
6. Allows rendering multiple graphic layers over the running video output.
7. Output preview feature.
8. Allows rendering still and animated graphics.
9. Supports all fonts including the Unicode fonts.
10. Allow rendering dynamically updated text.
11. Looping and single pass crawls for ticker text.
12. Full control over the speed of each crawl layer.
13. Easy creation of timers/counters (count-down) and digital clocks.
14. Allows simultaneous rendering of real-time graphics including crawls and rolling.
15. Allows real-time editing to the graphics template without disturbing other templates.
16. Allow rendering subtitles through .CIP or .SRT file and through automation packets.
17. Allow custom positioning of the subtitles coming through automation packets, .CIP file and .SRT file.
18. Allow playing Emergency Alert Message on screen in emergency situations using EAS feature.
19. Allow complete Graphics.X server backup and restore.

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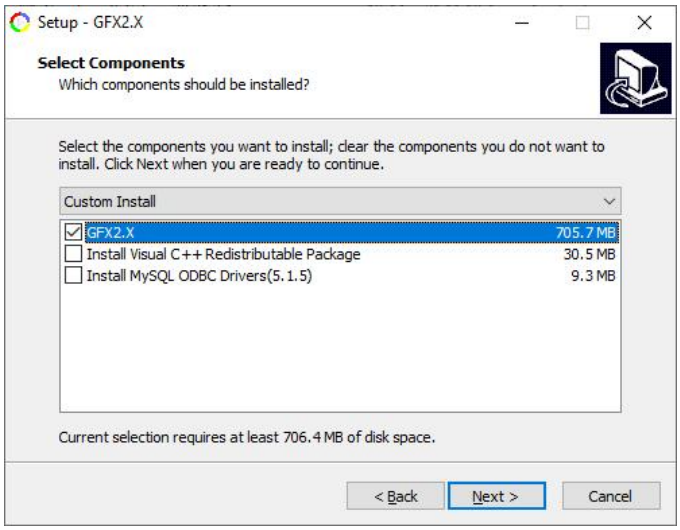
# 3. Installation

1. Double-click the **GFX2.X setup** file to launch the installation wizard.

2. Browse and select **destination location/ directory path** where you wish to install the GFX2.X on your system and click "**Next**" to proceed the installation.

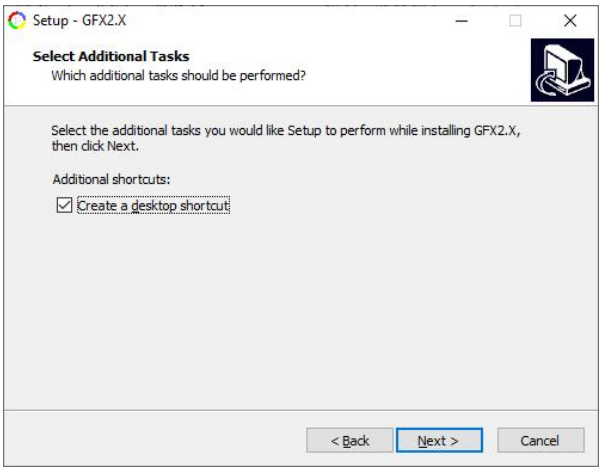



3. Select **GFX2.X** and other **components** such as **VC++ Redistributable Package** and **MySQL ODBC Driver** to install and click "**Next**". (Keep unchecked the component if already installed)

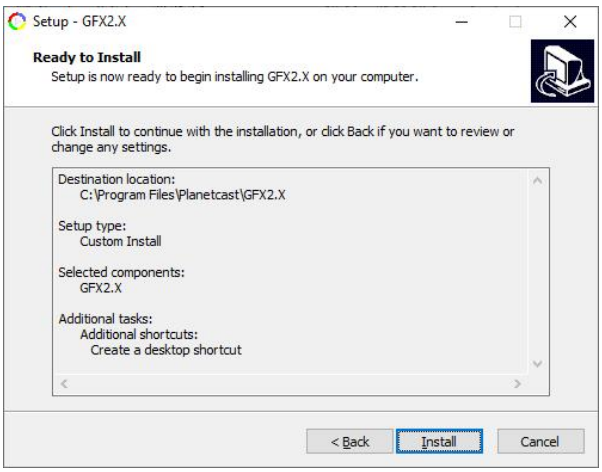



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4. Check the option to "**Create a desktop shortcut**" and click "**Next**".




5. Review your installation selection and click "**Install**" to begin the installation.

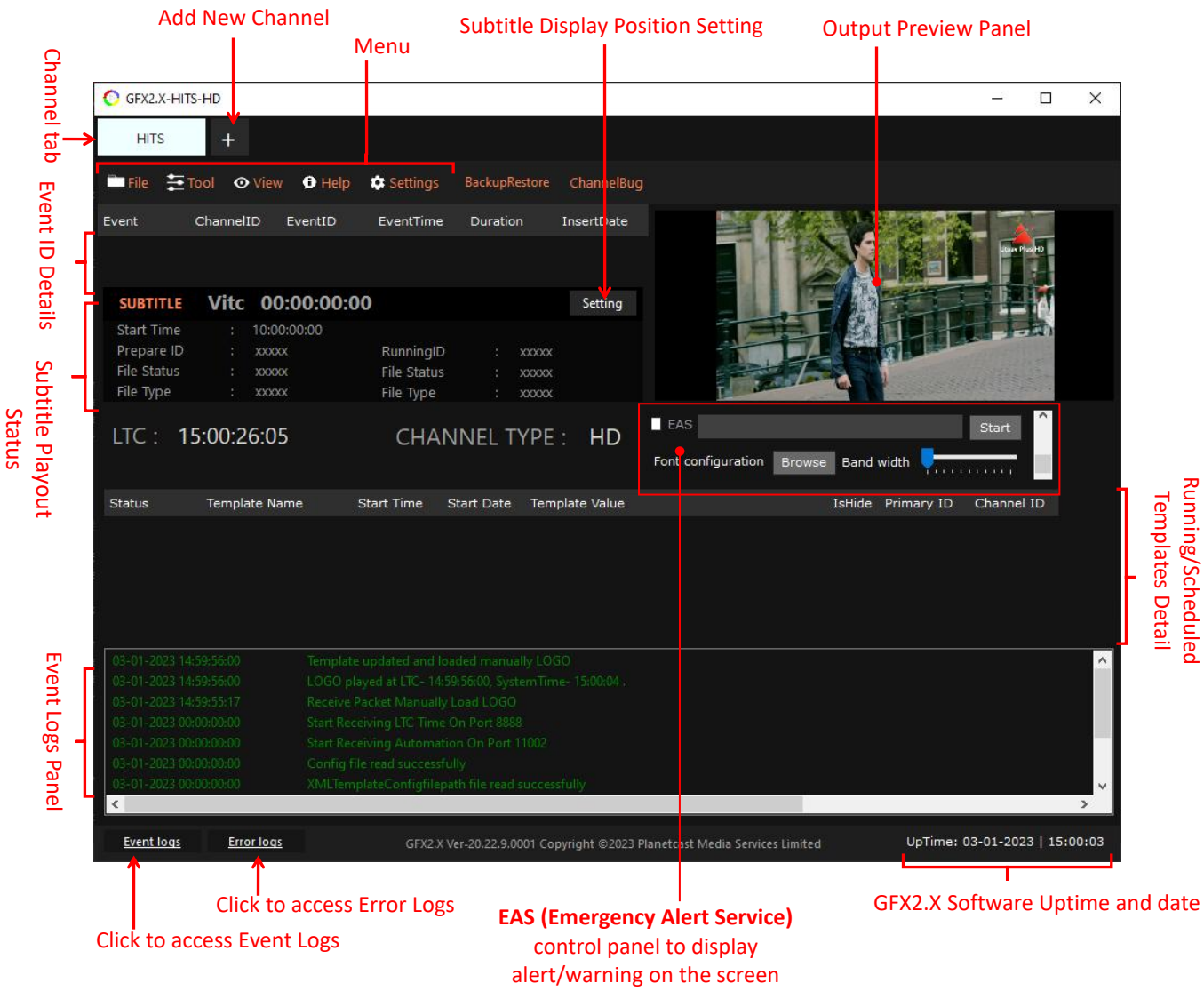



6. On completing the installation, check the option "**Launch GFX2.X(64)**" to launch the GFX2.X server.
7. Click "**Finish**" to close the Setup.




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# 4. GFX2.X GUI




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# 5. Getting Started

## 5.1. Adding a new channel

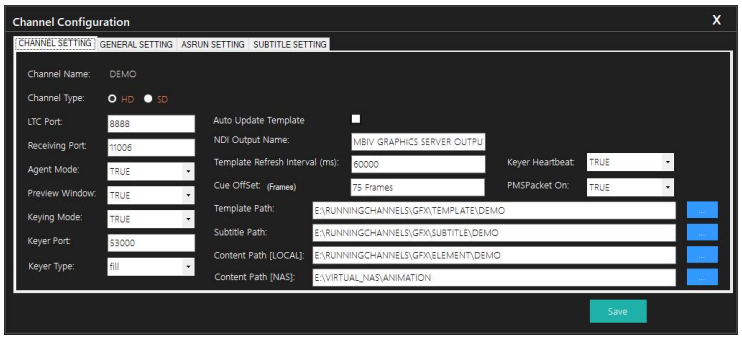
1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the "**Plus**"  icon This will open up a window to add new channel.
3. Click "**Create**" button
4. Enter "**Name of the Channel**" as per preference.
5. Click "**Create**". This will create new channel.
6. Finally, Click "**Add**" button to add this newly created channel to **GFX2.X** server.




Congratulation, you have successfully added a new channel to GFX2.X. Now you can move ahead setting up its configuration.

## 5.2. Set channel configuration

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose Configuration you wish to set.
3. Go to "**Setting**" menu and click "**Channel Config**". This will open Channel Config Manager.
4. Go to "**CHANNEL SETTING**" tab.
   a) Set **Channel Type** as **SD** or **HD** by selecting respective radio option.
   b) Enter **LTC Port** and PMS Command **Receiving port**.
   c) Enable "**Agent Mode**", if you wish to use it with Graphics Agent.
   d) Enable "**Preview Window**", if you wish to preview graphics output in its Preview window.




   e) Enable "**Keying Mode"**, if you wish to use it with KEYER application and enter "**Keyer Port**" and set "**Keyer Type**".
   f) Enable "**PMS Packet On**", if you wish to receive packets from Automation (PMS).
   g) Check the "**Auto Update Template**" option, to allow auto updating of template.
   h) Enter "**NDI Output Name**" as per preference.
   i) Enter "**Template Refresh Interval (ms)**", so that the template can refresh in specified interval.
   j) Enter preferred value for "**Cue Offset (Frames)**".
   k) Choose "**Template Path**" from where the GFX2.X server picks the graphic templates.
   l) Choose "**Subtitle Path**" from where the GFX2.X server picks the subtitle file.
   m) Choose "**Content Path[Local]**", if the content (.mov files) is stored at local system.
   n) Choose "**Content Path[NAS]**", if the content (.mov files) is stored at NAS storage.
   o) Set "**Keyer Heartbeat**" to "**True**", if you want GFX2.X server to get Keyer Heartbeat. (Only when "**Keying Mode**" is "**TRUE**")
   p) Set "**PMS Packet**" to "**On**", if you want GFX2.X server to get PMS packet for GFX playout. (Only when GFX playout is done on the basis of received PMS command)

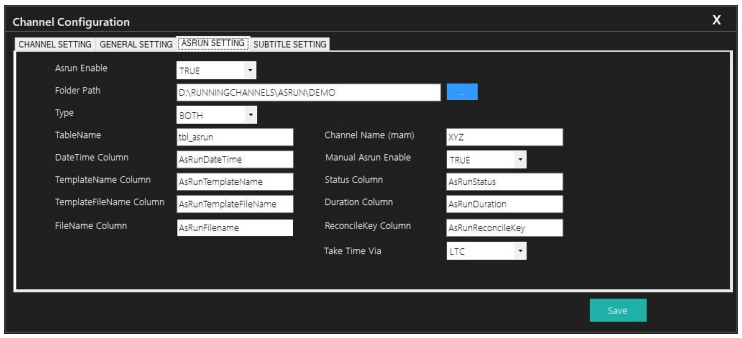
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5. Go to "**GENERAL SETTING**" tab.
   a) Enable **DB Settings** and enter Database information i.e ***DB Type***, ***DB Name***, ***DB IP Address***, ***DB Username***, ***DB Password***, ***DB Port***.
   b) Enter **Commercial Prefix**, **Promo Prefix**, **Program Prefix**.
   c) Enable "**Reconcile Check**", if you wish to enable the event reconciliation.
   d) Enable "**Subtitle Check**", if you wish to enable the subtitle check property.




   e) Enable "**Overlapping Check**", if you wish to prevent graphics overlapping.
   f) Enter "**Event Checking Time**" so that application will keep checking for new events after this interval.
   g) Enable "**SCTE Enable**" property, if you wish to receive SCTE trigger for source switching.
   h) Enter "**SCTE Template Name**", **SCTE IP**, **SCTE Port** and **SCTE Preroll counter value**.

6. Go to "**ASRUN SETTING**" tab.
   a) Enable "**ASRUN Enable**" property, if you wish to generate ASRUN for played graphics.
   b) Browse and select "**Folder Path**" where you wish to save ASRUN file.
   c) Select preferred Type *(i.e **File, DB, Both***) for ASRUN.
   d) Enter **Table Name** in which the ASRUN records are updated.




   e) Enter **Channel Name (mam)** (Same as defined in MAM System).
   f) Enable "**Manual Asrun Enable**" property, if you wish to create Asrun manually.
   g) Enter preferred name for **Date Time Column**, **Template Name Column**, **Template File Name Column**, **File Name Column**, **Status Column**, **Duration Column** and **Reconcile Key Column**.
   h) Select preferred "**Take Time Via**" option i.e either **LTC** or **System Time** so that GFX2.X can take time accordingly.

7. Go to "**SUBTITLE SETTING**" tab.
   a) Enable "**Subtitle Setting**" property, if you wish to play subtitle.
   b) Set "**Subtitle Mode**" to **Manual** or **Automation** as per requirement.
   c) Select preferred "**File Type**" option (i.e **CIP**, **SRT** or **Both**).
   d) Enter "**Subtitle Port**" at which GFX2.X receives subtitles from automation.




   e) Enter **Start Offset (Frames)**, **End Offset (Frames)**, **Subtitle Template Name**, **Subtitle Suffix**.

8. Click "**Save**" button.

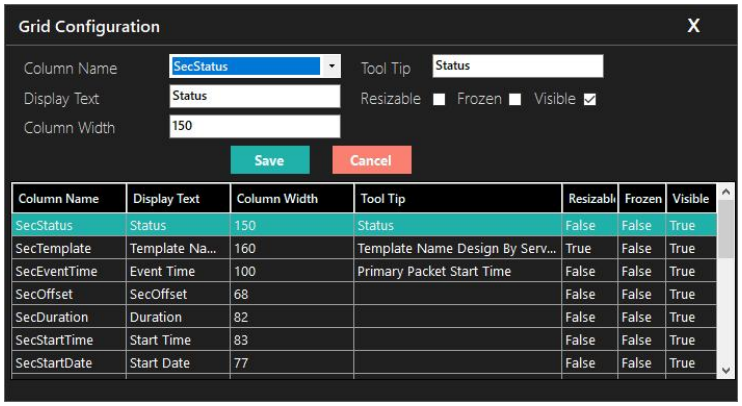
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Now, GFX2.X works for this Channel's graphics based on the settings you just defined above.

Once you defined the Channel Configuration, move ahead for defining the Grid Configuration for this Channel.

## 5.3. Set grid configuration

In grid configuration you will define column names to display graphics information in respective columns, enable/disable the columns to appear in grid, set with of each column independently, freeze a column on grid etc. Below process illustrating the same:




1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose Grid Configuration you wish to set.
3. Go to **Settings > Grid Config**. This will open Grid Config Manager.
4. Choose a **Column Name** that you wish to see in grid.
5. Enter preferred "**Text**" to display on the header of the chosen Column.
6. Set preferred "**Width**" for this Column.
7. Enter preferred **Text** to appear as a tool tip while hovering the mouse over that Column Name/Header.
8. Put check-mark on "**Resizable**" option, to make this Column resizable.
9. Put check-mark on "**Frozen**" option, to freeze this Column in grid.
10. Put check-mark on "**Visible**" option, to make this Column visible in grid.
11. Repeat above steps to add more columns in grid.
12. Click "**Save**".

Now the Columns that you have selected here in this process will appear in grid to display information of the templates such as *Template Name, Event Time, Sec Offset, Duration* etc.

You can easily manage this grid configuration simply by selecting a Column Name listed in grid and enable/disable the required property related to that Column.

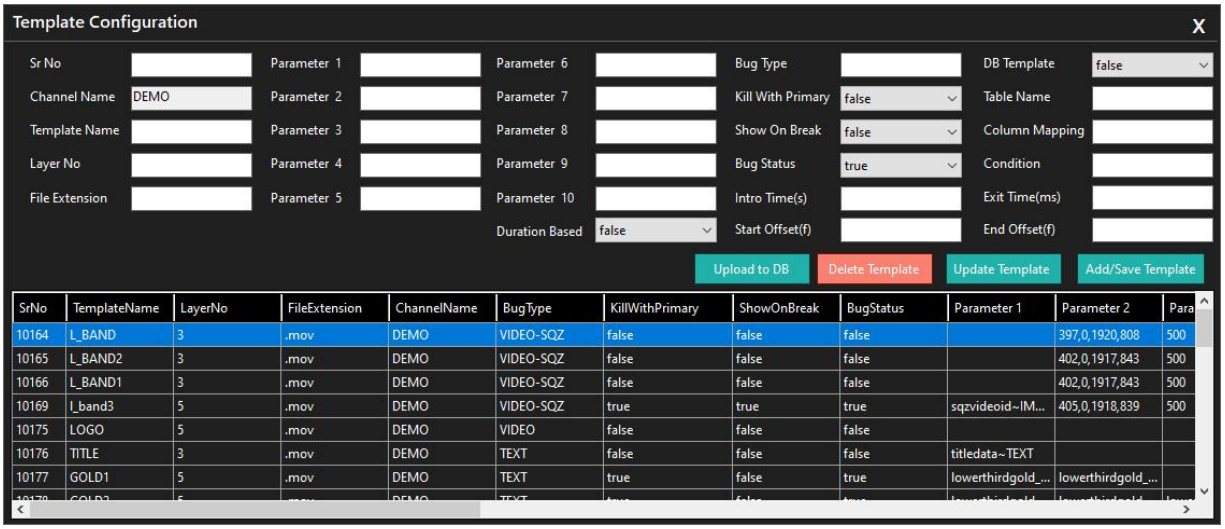
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## 5.4. Set template configuration

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose Template Configuration you wish to set.
3. Go to **Settings > Template Config**. This will open Template Config Manager.
4. Enter **Sr. No.** (should be Unique), **Channel Name**, **Template Name**, **Layer No.** (*i.e layer on which this template will appear on screen*), **File Extension** (*such as* ***.mov***).
5. Enter appropriate values in **Parameter 1**, **Parameter 2** .... and **Parameter 10** (*For example:* ***abc~.mov***).
6. Enter "**Bug Type**" as appropriate such as VIDEO if the template is of Logo, or TEXT if the the template is of Ticker.
7. Enable "**Kill with Primary**" option, if you wish to kill this running template when its Primary event finishes its playout.
8. Enable "**Show on Break**" option, if you wish to make this template visible on screen during break.
9. Enable "**Bug Status**" option, if you wish to see bug status.
10. Set "**DB Template**" to "**True**", if you wish to use DB to update template information.
11. Enter "**Table Name**" in which the template information is stored.
12. Define "**Column Mapping**" and "**Condition**".
13. Enter "**Intro Time(s)**", "**Exit Time(ms)**".
14. Enable or disable the "**Duration Based**" property so as to play template on the basis of its duration.
15. Enter "**Start Offset(f)**" (in frames), "**End Offset(f)**" (in frames).
16. Click "**Add/Save Template**" button.
17. Click "**Update to DB**", if you wish to update this template in database. (*This feature should only be enabled when Database property is enabled in Channel Config*.)
18. Repeat above steps to add more Templates.

Now, the Template you add here will be listed down in grid. You can anytime edit these templates by first selecting the temple in below grid, making required changes and clicking the "**Update Template**"; button. Similarly, you can anytime delete these templates by first selecting the template in below grid and clicking the "**Delete Template**" button.

Refer below screenshot displaying the Template Configuration window.




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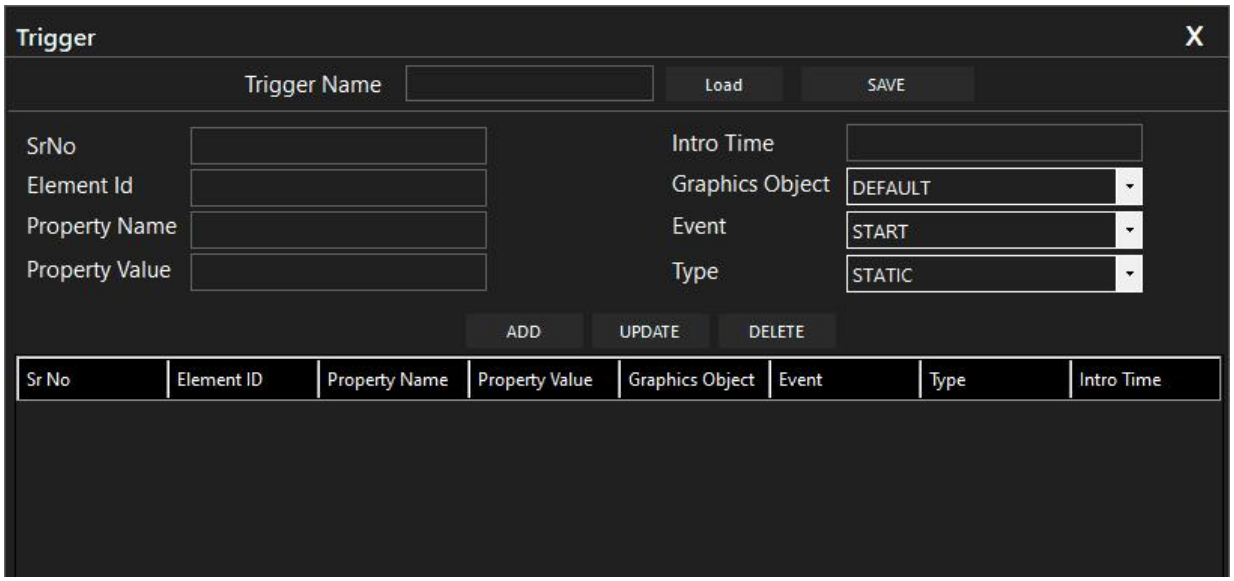
## 5.5. Add trigger setting

Trigger can be added either by defining the trigger settings in respective fields or just by uploading the **.tgr** file containing the trigger settings.

### a) Define trigger setting

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose Trigger Setting you wish to define.
3. Go to **Settings > Trigger Setting**. This will open Trigger Settings panel.
4. Enter **Sr. No.** (should be Unique).
5. Enter **Intro Time** (Duration for which this graphics object will be triggered .
6. Enter **Element Id** (Graphics Element ID/Name).
7. Enter **Property Name** (for e.g. “show”).
8. Enter **Property Value** (for e.g “no” to hide the other graphics when this graphics is triggered).
9. Select appropriate “**Graphics Object**” which is to be displayed by this trigger.
10. Select preferred ”**Event**” such as “START”. and “**Type**” such as “STATIC”.
11. Click “**Add**” button to save or add this trigger.

This newly added trigger will be available in the grid below. You can anytime update this trigger by clicking on this trigger and clicking the “**Update**” button. Similarly, you can easily delete this trigger by selecting it in grid and clicking the “**Delete**” button.



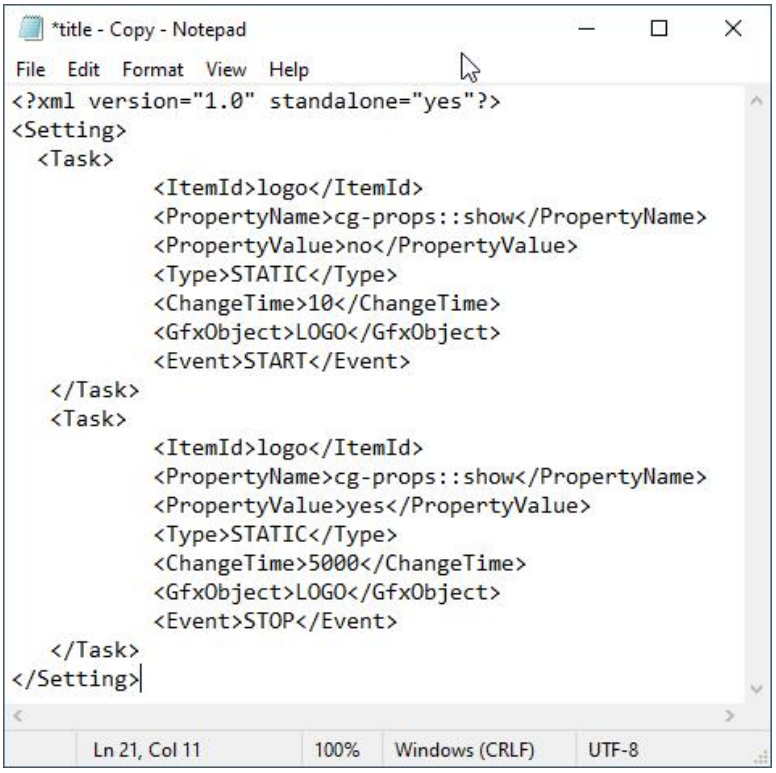

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## b) Upload trigger setting

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose Trigger Setting you wish to define.
3. Go to **Settings > Trigger Setting**. This will open Trigger Settings panel.
4. Enter "**Trigger Name**".
5. Enter "**Load**" button to upload trigger settings (**.tgr**) file.
6. Click "**Save**" button to save this trigger.

This newly added trigger will be available in the grid below. You can anytime update this trigger by clicking on this trigger and clicking the "**Update**" button. Similarly, you can easily delete this trigger by selecting it in grid and clicking the "**Delete**" button.

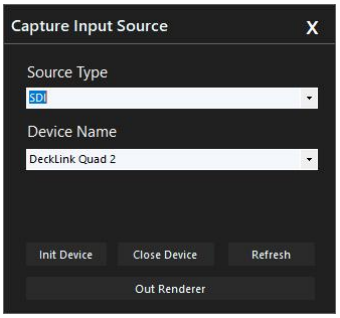
Refer below screenshot displaying the trigger setting (**.trg**) file format.




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## 5.6. Set Render property to capture source

This property will be enabled when the "**Keying Mode**" property is "**False**" in "**Channel Configuration**" or when GFX2.X will be running without KEYER.

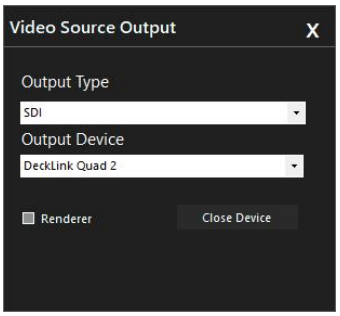



1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **Video Source Capture** property you wish to set.
3. Go to "**Tools**" menu and click "**Set Render**" menu option.
4. Select "**Source Type**" i.e either **SDI** or **NDI**, through which you wish to capture video source from Playout Automation Server.
5. Click "**Refresh**" button to refresh the list of available input sources in Device Name field.
6. Choose appropriate **Device Name** from available source list.
7. Click "**Init Device**" button, to initialize the **GFX2.X** application for capturing the video source.
8. Click "**Out Renderer**" button to set Video Output Rendering property. (This feature is explained in next section)

Now the GFX2.X is ready to capture the video source you have just chosen in above settings.

## 5.7. Set Output Rendering property

This property can also be defined in "**Set Renderer**" property by clicking the "**Out Renderer**" button. In this, you will define video output rendering property so that the **GFX2.X** software can render out the captured video source after keying in the rendered graphics with video source.




1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **Output Rendering** property you wish to set.
3. Go to "**Tools**" menu and click "**Render Out**" menu option.
4. Select "**Output Type**" i.e either **SDI** or **NDI**, through which you wish to render output for playout.
5. Choose appropriate "**Output Device**" i.e *SDI Card for SDI output* or an *NDI Interface for NDI output*.
6. Put check-mark on "**Renderer**" to initialize the chosen Output Rendering Port/Device.

Now the **GFX2.X** server starts rendering the output (video source + graphics) through the Device/Port you have just chosen in above settings. Whenever the Playout Automation Server send command to play or stop a graphics template then GFX2.X starts rendering the output with graphics on defined port/device.

You can anytime stop this output rendering simply by clicking selecting the source and clicking the "**Close Device**" button.

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## 5.8. Load/Unload Graphics Manually

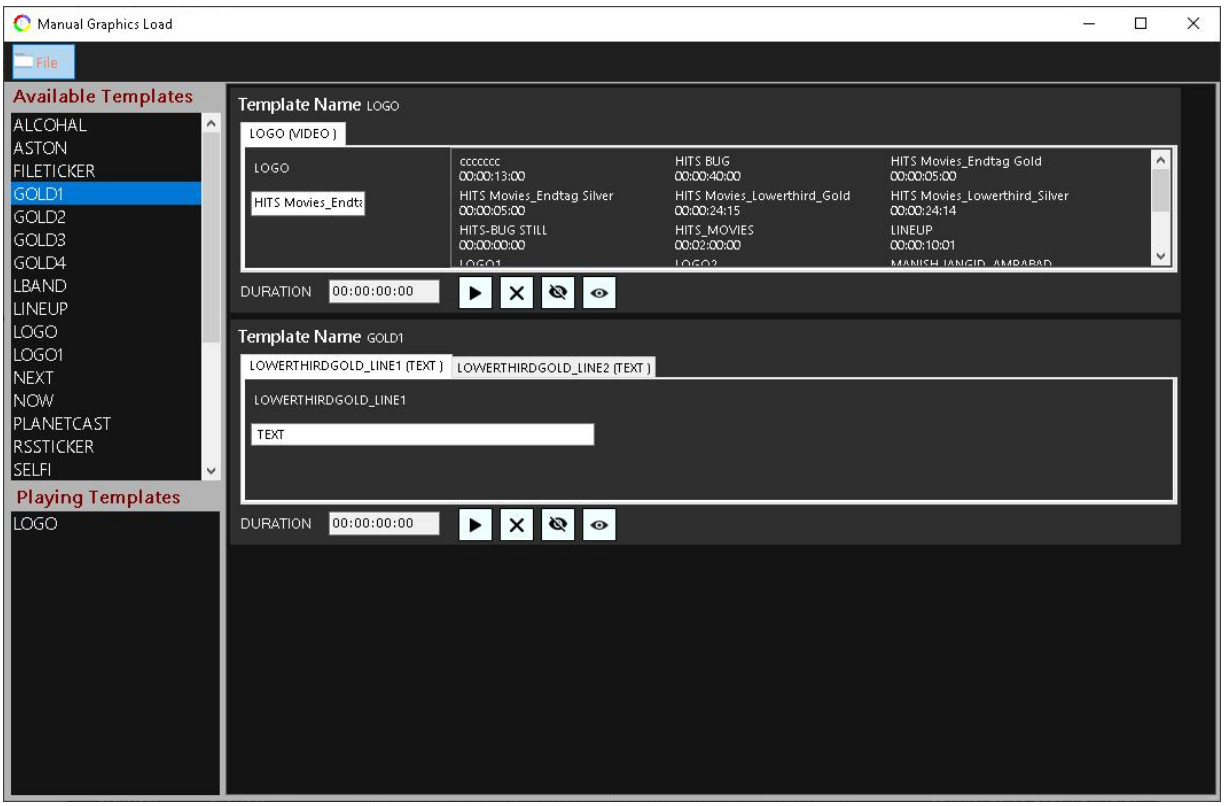
This feature is one of the useful feature of the GFX2.X software that empower the user to Load/Unload a graphics template manually as per preference. It will also helps the user to hide/unhide a running graphics from output. Below process illustrating the same.

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **graphics playout** you wish to control manually.
3. Go to "**Tools**" menu and click "**Manual Graphics Load**" menu option.
4. Drag a Graphics Template Category from "**Available Templates**" to main Canvas on right. Let say we drag a GOLD Template.
5. Enter LOWERTHIRGOLD_LINE1 Text and LOWERTHIRGOLD_LINE1 Text.
6. Put "**Duration**" upto which this Template should be played.
7. Click "**Play**" button.

The above process will immediately starts playing the this graphics template over the video. Following the same process, you can play multiple template from this single interface/canvas as per the requirement of the channel's output.

While it is running, you can anytime **stop playing** this template by clicking the "**Stop**" button. Similarly, you can "**Hide**" or "**Unhide**" this template from screen by clicking the respective "**Hide Template**" or "**Show Template**" button.

Refer below screenshot displaying the Manual Graphics Load window.




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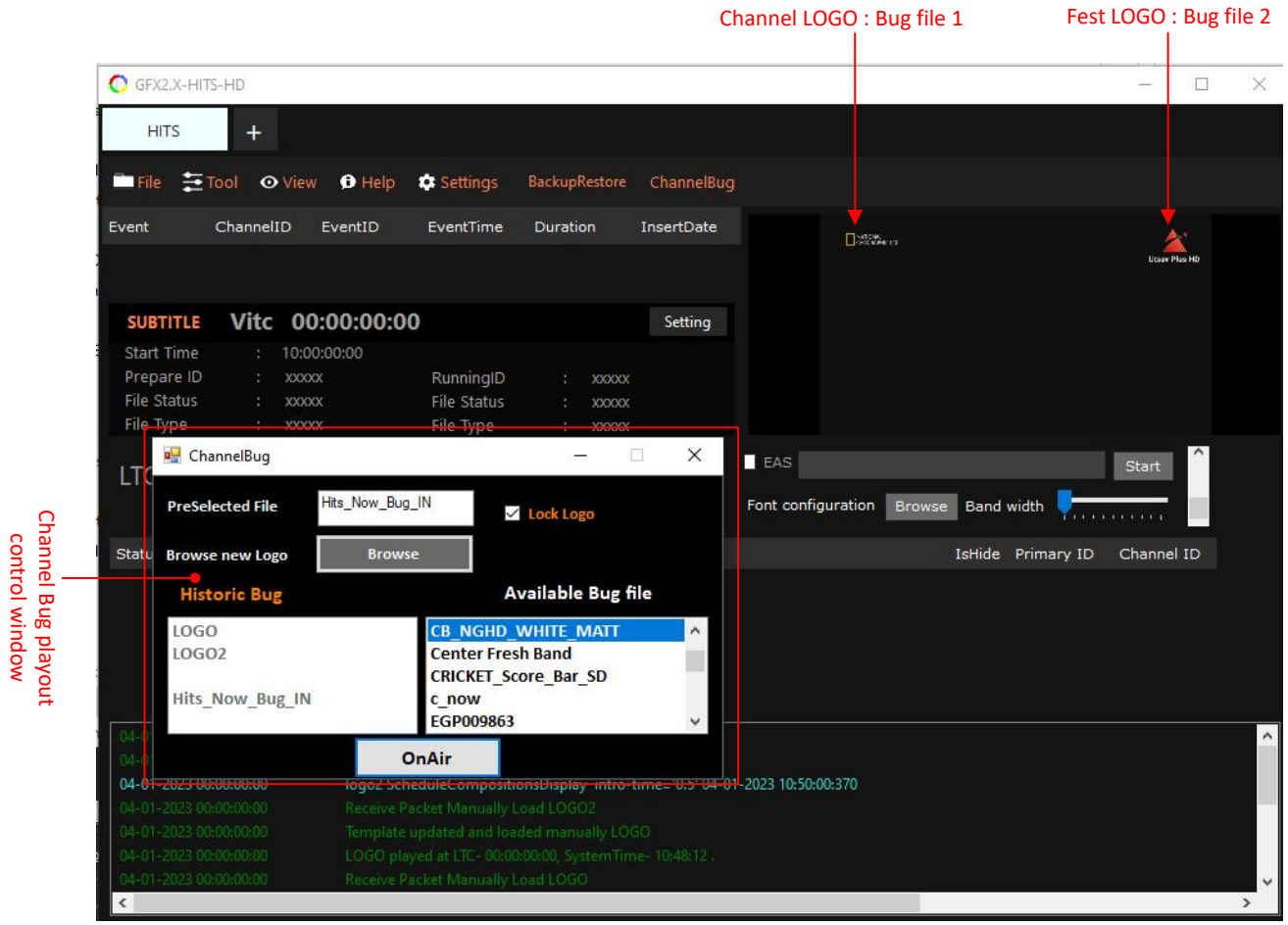
## 5.9. Manually load & on-air 2 Bug/logo files

This feature is also a useful feature with which user can control playout of 2 logo files **(1 Channel Logo + 1 Fest Logo)** on screen at respective positions. Below process is illustrating the same.

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **graphics playout** you wish to control manually.
3. Click "**Channel Bug**" menu tab. This will open **channel bug playout control window**.
4. Click "**Browse**" button, then browse and select the preferred **Bug file** such as **Fest LOGO** to add it in "**Available Bug File**" list.
5. Just select the **Bug file** that you just added into the **Available Bug File** list and you wish to on-air.
6. Select the "**Lock Logo**" check-box option, if you wish to play it with another Bug file which is already playing. This will save the current running bug file i.e **Channel Logo** position.
7. Finally, click "**On Air**" button. This will start playing the chosen Bug file on screen without disturbing/halting the playout of the channel logo.

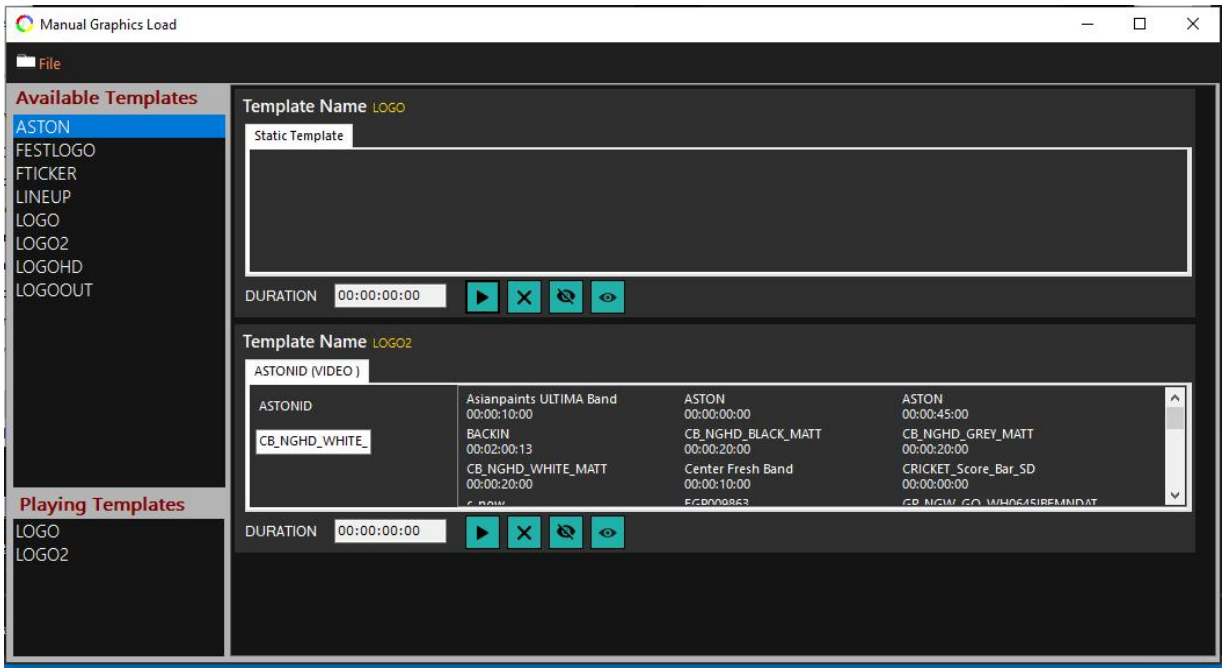
The above process will play **2 LOGO files (1 Channel Logo + 1 Fest Logo)** on screen at respective positions.

Refer below screenshot displaying the same:




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You can easily stop playing any one of the **2 Logos/Bug files** by navigating to "**Tools**" menu **>** "**Manual Graphics Load**" menu option and clicking the "**Stop**" button provided for that playing/running Bug file.




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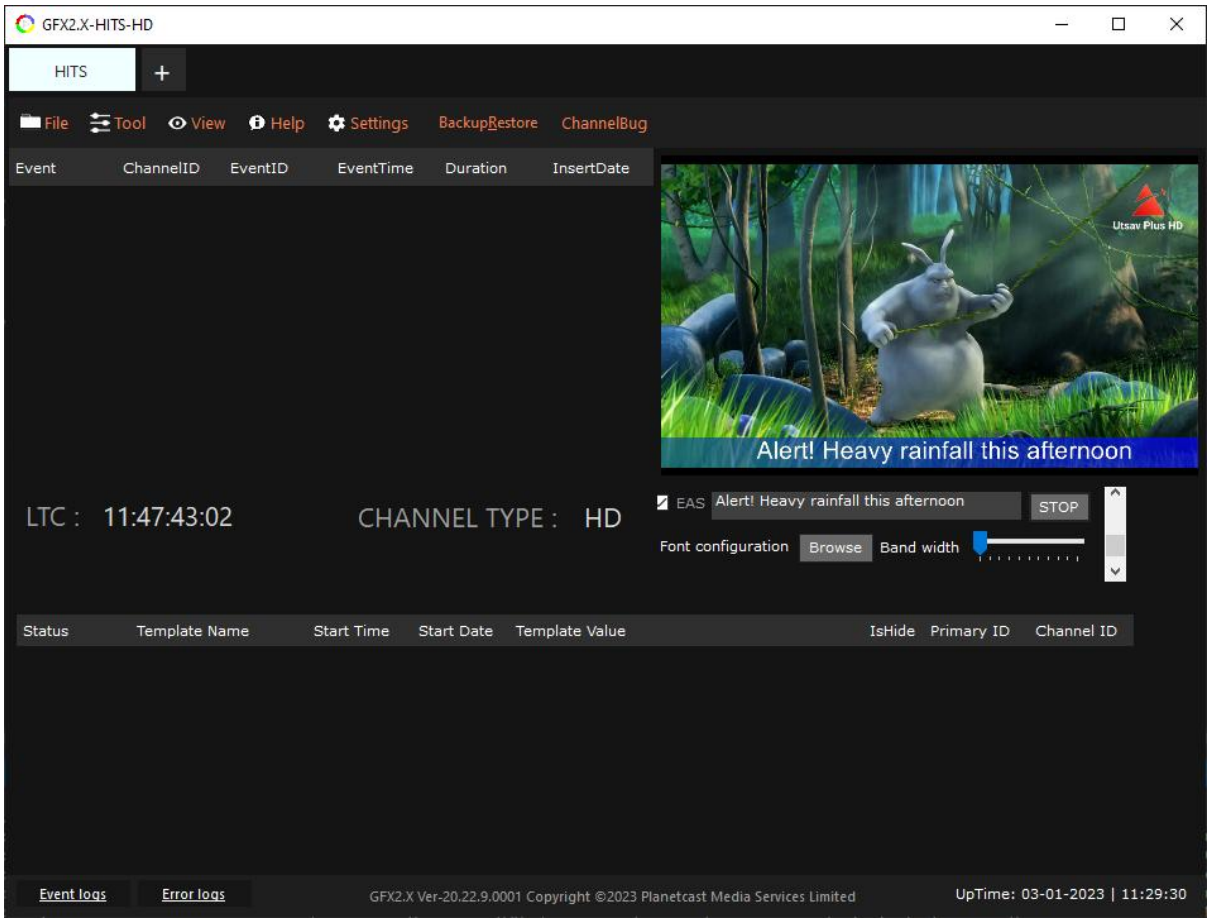
## 5.10. Manually fire Emergency Alert Message using EAS feature

This feature allow you to enable or disable the **EAS (Emergency Alert Service)** and fire the custom emergency warning or alert message over the primary video on screen.

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **graphics playout** you wish to control manually.
3. Go to the **EAS Control Panel** provided just below the Output Preview Panel.
4. Put the check-mark on "**EAS ON**" feature just below the Output Preview window to enable EAS feature.
5. Enter the **Emergency Alert Message** that you want to display over the running primary video.
6. Click "**Browse**" and select preferred font configuration.
7. Drag the "**Band Width**" slider to set width of the band appearing behind the EAS Message.
8. Drag and set the **Vertical Position** of the EAS Message.
9. Click "**START**" button to play the Emergency Alert Message.

The above process will immediately start playing the crawling **Emergency Alert Message** over the running video in continuous loop. User can anytime stop this EAS service by clicking the "**STOP**" button.

Refer below screenshot displaying the **EAS Message** playing over the primary video.




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## 5.11. Show/Hide Preview

This feature will help you to enable or disable the "**Preview Window**" property without going to "**Channel Configuration**". By enabling this property, the Rendered Output can be previewed in GFX2.X's Preview Window.

Follow the below process to Show/Hide the Output Preview.

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **Output Preview** feature you wish to enable/disable.
3. Go to "**View**" menu and just click "**Show/Hide Preview**" menu option.

If the "**Preview Window**" property in Channel Configuration is set to "**False**", then by clicking the "**Show/Hide Preview**" menu option, the output rendered by the GFX2.X becomes visible in Preview Window.

On the other hand, If the "**Preview Window**" property in Channel Configuration is set to "**True**", then by clicking the "**Show/Hide Preview**" menu option, the output rendered by the GFX2.X becomes invisible in Preview Window.

## 5.12. Show/Hide Event Logs

This feature helps you to enable or disable the "**Log Panel**" display. This feature when clicked or enabled, allows you to see logs related to all events carried out by GFX2.X for rendering the graphics.

Follow the below process to Show/Hide the Output Preview

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **Event Logs** display you wish to enable/disable.
3. Go to "**View**" menu and just click "**Show/Hide Event Logs**" menu option.

If the Logs panel is disabled, then by clicking this feature you can enable its display at the bottom and hence can view Event Logs. You can disable the Logs Panel display by clicking the same "**Show/Hide Event Logs**" feature.

You can also access event logs file simply by clicking the "**Event Logs**" hyperlink provided at the footer on left.

## 5.13. Error Logs

This feature helps you to access error logs so that you can get details related to the errors occurred in graphics rendering. Follow the below process to access Error Logs.

1. Launch the **GFX2.X** application.
2. Click the **Channel** tab whose **Error Logs** you wish to see.
3. Go to **GFX2.X** application footer and click "**Error Logs**" hyperlink.

The above process will open the Error Log file where you can see logs related to graphics error.

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## 5.14. Backup & Restore GFX2.X Server

GFX2.X server with its Backup feature enables the user to take complete backup of the GFX2.X server including all of its configurations.

This backup can anytime be restored back to the graphics playout directory to get back the GFX2.X server ready with all your last saved configurations and settings.

Before using the backup feature, you must set the Backup folder path where GFX2.X server save its backup.

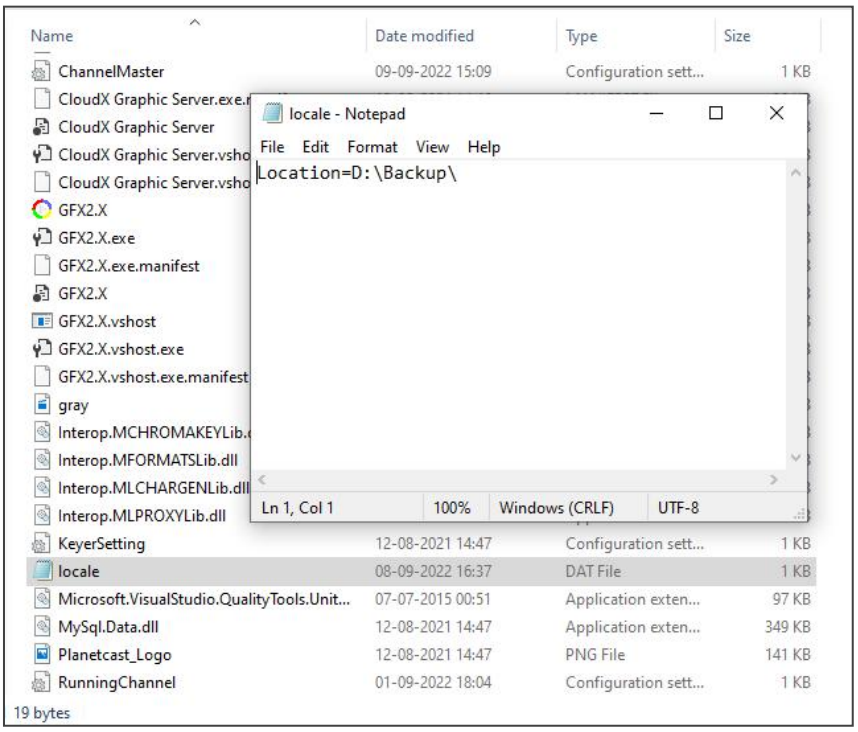
### 5.14.1. Setup path for backup

The below process is illustrating the procedure to set backup folder path where the backup will be saved.

1. Go to the **GFX2.X** application installation path.
2. Open the "**locale.dat**" file.
3. Enter absolute folder path where you want to take the GFX2.X server backup.
4. **Save** and **close** the **locale.dat** file.

Now, whenever you take GFX2.X server backup, it will be saved in the folder set by you in **locale.dat** file.

Refer below screenshot displaying the "**locale.dat**" file.




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### 5.14.2. Backup the GFX2.X Server

The Backup feature helps in safeguard each and every single file, configurations, settings of the latest good running state of GFX2.X server application.

The below process is illustrating the procedure to take GFX2.X server backup:

1. Click the Channel tab whose backup you wish to take.
2. Click the "**BackupRestore**" menu tab.
3. Click the "**Backup**" option.
4. Click "**Yes**" when prompted to take backup.

The above process immediately take the complete backup of the GFX2.X application including all of its configurations and settings at path set by you in "**locale.dat**" file. You can check that backup by navigating to that folder/drive on your system.

### 5.14.3. Restore the Graphics.X server backup

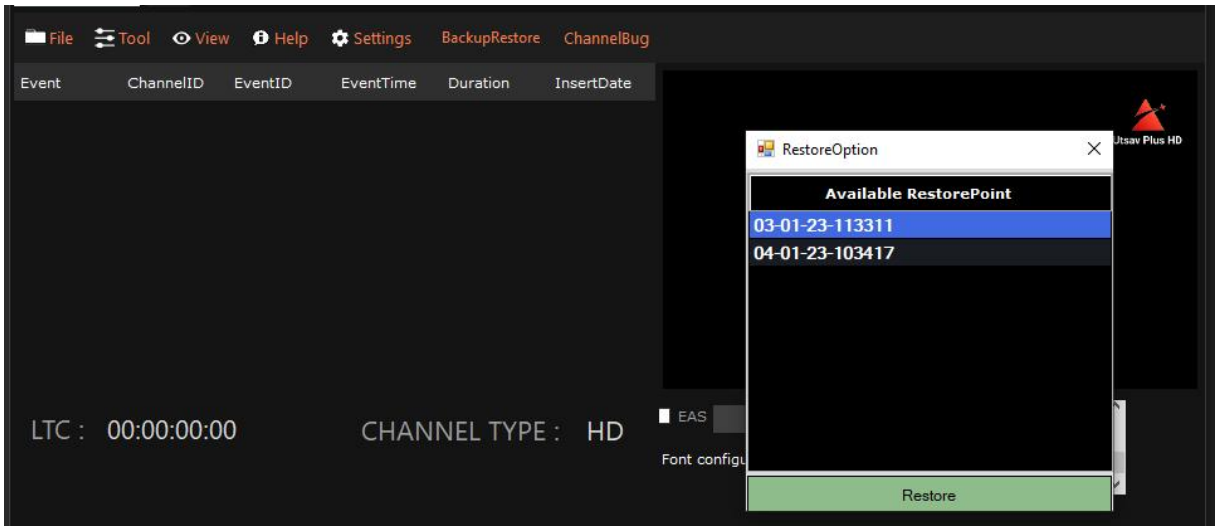
The backup you have taken in the above process can easily be restored back to retrieve the last saved configuration and settings of GFX2.X server.

The below process is illustrating the procedure to restore GFX2.X server backup:

1. Click the **Channel** tab whose backup you wish to restore.
2. Click the "**BackupRestore**" menu tab.
3. Click the "**Restore**" option. This will open a window displaying the list of all the backups.
4. Click to select a backup/available restore point that you wish to restore.
5. Click "**Restore**" button.
6. Click "**Yes**" when prompted to restore the chosen backup.

The above process immediately restore or get back the complete GFX2.X server including all of its files, configurations and settings as were in the chosen backup.

Refer below screenshot displaying the Restore feature window.




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